

Debate Motions

1. Average grades. Ordinary CCA experience. A slim chance of getting into a prestigious university overseas. This is the profile of the average kid. He should stay local.

Scope (not exhaustive)

- The issue of competition
 - How prepared are students from Singapore to cope with the academic rigor/workload overseas?
 - Might the local environment/curriculum actually be tougher?
- Admissions
 - What are prestigious universities looking for?
 - Is the student's case as hopeless as it seems?
- What 'average' students can get out of an overseas education

Time Allocated: About 10 minutes

2. There is no point in studying abroad because a local education plus overseas exchanges is equally good.

Scope (not exhaustive)

- (Singapore) Opportunities for exposure and a well-rounded education, e.g.: exchange programs, collaboration with universities overseas (MIT-SUTD, ZJU-SUTD)
- (Overseas) The full package, e.g.: cultural immersion, big-name professors, 365 days/year & 24hours/day, independence

Time Allocated: About 10 minutes

3. Go overseas and become homesick. Stay local and get sick of home.

Scope (not exhaustive)

- Challenge both sides
- 'Go overseas and become homesick'
 - Challenge the notion that homesickness is inevitable and a deal-breaker
- 'Stay local and get sick of home'
 - A change of environment, more 'international' faces/diversity of student body, exchange programs

Time Allocated: About 10 minutes

4. I would choose the same University option if I could choose again.

Scope of discussion (not exhaustive)

- Open

Time Allocated: About 10 minutes